

Activity 12 Instruction Manual

Activity 12 | Topic 02 | C013 | Version v1.0

Purpose

Knowledge that lives only in people's heads leaves when they do. You will use GenAI to turn messy project conversations into a structured, searchable knowledge asset and a lessons-learned register.

Files used

- activity-guide.md and activity-guide.pdf - brief and source instructions
- prompts.pdf - reusable prompt and verification checklist
- mock-data.xlsx - safe fictional project data for practice

Expected output

A lessons-learned register and a knowledge asset entry for your project.

Before you begin

1. Form the required group and assign one person to capture evidence.
2. Open mock-data.xlsx and review the title, note and column headings.
3. Open prompts.pdf beside your chosen GenAI tool. Do not upload confidential workplace data.

Detailed procedure

1. In your group, write a realistic 'messy input': meeting notes, a chat thread and an email chain about a project problem - roughly a page in total. Invent it if you need to.
2. Prompt GenAI: 'From these project records, extract: (1) decisions made and who made them, (2) open questions, (3) lessons learned, (4) tacit knowledge that is implied but never stated explicitly.'
3. Examine point 4 closely - surfacing tacit knowledge (the 'everyone knows that the vendor is slow in December' type of insight) is where GenAI adds real value here.
4. Build a lessons-learned register entry for each lesson: what happened, the impact, the root cause and the recommendation for future projects.
5. Prompt: 'Rewrite each lesson so it is actionable by a project manager who knows nothing about this project.' Vague lessons are useless lessons.
6. Decide what belongs in the organisational process assets versus what is project-specific, and mark each entry accordingly.
7. Discuss as a group: what are the confidentiality risks of pasting real project records into a public GenAI tool, and what would your organisation's policy allow?

Use the supplied mock data

Copy only the rows needed for the current step and tell the model the data is fictional. If the model changes an identifier or number, reject the change and rerun with an explicit preserve-values instruction.

Quality control

- Your register has actionable lessons with root causes, at least one item of genuinely tacit knowledge surfaced, and your group can state your organisation's data-confidentiality limits.
- Compare the first AI draft with the final human-corrected artifact and retain both as evidence.
- Label assumptions, decisions, owners and dates so another project manager can audit the result.

Troubleshooting

If the response is generic, add the project objective, constraints, audience and required columns. If arithmetic is inconsistent, request formulas and substitutions, then calculate independently. If a source cannot be opened, remove the claim or replace it with verified evidence.

Submission evidence

Submit the completed project artifact, the final prompt, a short critique of the AI output, and any screenshot or exported file required by the activity.